Sentences & Clauses (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Simple sentences: Is 'The river flooded the village' a simple sentence? Explain why.

Answer: Yes — it has one main clause (one subject, river, and one verb, flooded) and expresses one complete idea.

Compound sentences: Turn these two simple sentences into one compound sentence: 'The bell rang. The pupils lined up.'

Answer: 'The bell rang, and the pupils lined up.' — two main clauses joined by the coordinating conjunction 'and', each able to stand alone.

Complex sentences: In 'Although it was late, she finished her homework,' identify the main clause and the subordinate clause.

Answer: Main clause: 'she finished her homework' (makes sense alone). Subordinate clause: 'Although it was late' (cannot stand alone — it depends on the main clause).

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Is this a simple sentence? 'The baker opened the shop early.' Explain your answer.
2. Identify the main clause in: 'The dog barked loudly.'
3. Which sentence below is a simple sentence? A) The sun rose, and the birds sang. B) The sun rose. C) When the sun rose, the birds sang. D) The sun rose because it was morning. E) Although it was early, the sun rose.
4. Join these two simple sentences into one compound sentence using 'and': 'The kettle boiled. Mum made tea.'
5. Underline the subordinate clause: 'Because it was raining, we stayed inside.'
6. Underline the main clause: 'Because it was raining, we stayed inside.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are coordinating conjunctions used to build compound sentences? A) and B) because C) but D) although E) or
8. Write one simple sentence about a football match.
9. Which sentence is a compound sentence? A) The lights flickered. B) The lights flickered because the storm hit. C) The lights flickered, and then they went out. D) When the storm hit, the lights flickered. E) The flickering lights were strange.
10. Join these two sentences with 'but' to make a compound sentence: 'He practised every day. He still lost the match.'
11. Identify the subject and the verb in this simple sentence: 'The children cheered.'
12. In 'The train was late, so we missed the start of the film,' which word joins the two main clauses? A) was B) late C) so D) missed E) start
13. Write a compound sentence of your own using the conjunction 'or'.
14. Explain why 'Running fast' is NOT a complete sentence.

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15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are complete simple sentences? A) The cat slept. B) Under the table. C) Birds flew south. D) Because it was cold. E) The bell rang.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. In 'When the alarm sounded, everyone left the building calmly,' identify the subordinate clause and the main clause.

2. Which sentence below is a complex sentence? A) The rain stopped, and the sun came out. B) The rain stopped. C) Although the rain stopped, the ground stayed wet. D) The rain stopped; the sun came out. E) The rain and the wind stopped.

3. Combine these two sentences into a complex sentence using 'although': 'She was tired. She finished the race.'

4. Identify the subordinating conjunction in: 'Since the museum closed early, we went to the park instead.'

5. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause, using an example of your own.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences are complex sentences? A) If it rains, the match will be cancelled. B) It rained, and the match was cancelled. C) The match was cancelled because it rained. D) It rained heavily all afternoon. E) Although it rained, the match continued.

7. Rewrite 'The wind howled. The waves crashed.' as one compound sentence using a semicolon instead of a conjunction.

8. Which word begins the subordinate clause in 'Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus'? A) Unless B) you C) hurry D) will E) miss

9. Explain why 'After the show finished' is a subordinate clause and not a complete sentence on its own.

10. Write a complex sentence that starts with the subordinating conjunction 'Because'.

11. Identify the two main clauses in this compound sentence: 'The chef prepared the meal, and the waiter served it.'

12. Which sentence correctly uses a comma after a fronted subordinate clause? A) When the bell rang the pupils stood up. B) When the bell rang, the pupils stood up. C) When, the bell rang the pupils stood up. D) When the bell, rang the pupils stood up. E) When the bell rang the, pupils stood up.

13. Turn this simple sentence into a complex sentence by adding a subordinate clause beginning with 'while': 'Dad cooked dinner.'

14. Explain why 'The dog that chased the ball was exhausted' is a complex sentence, identifying the main and subordinate clauses.

15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words can begin a subordinate clause? A) because B) and C) although D) but E) if

Red — Challenge (15 questions)

1. In 'The scientist who discovered the cure, although exhausted, refused to stop working,' identify the main clause and explain how you located it despite the interrupting clause.

2. Explain the difference between a compound sentence and a complex sentence, giving one original example of each.

3. Which sentence contains TWO subordinate clauses? A) Because it was cold, she wore a coat. B) Although it was late, she stayed, because she wanted to help. C) She wore a coat, and she wore a scarf. D) She wore a coat. E) It was cold, so she wore a coat.

4. Identify every clause (main or subordinate) in: 'When the tide came in, the children, who had been building sandcastles, ran back up the beach.'

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5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following are genuinely complete sentences (not fragments)? A) Because the bridge collapsed. B) The bridge collapsed suddenly. C) Running down the corridor. D) Firefighters arrived within minutes. E) Although firefighters arrived quickly.

6. Write one complex sentence containing an embedded (mid-sentence) subordinate clause, marked off with commas, then label the main clause and the subordinate clause.

7. In 'Having finished her homework, Priya, who was exhausted, went straight to bed,' which part is the main clause? A) Having finished her homework B) who was exhausted C) Priya went straight to bed D) Priya, who was exhausted E) finished her homework

8. Explain why a sentence can be both compound AND complex at the same time. Give one example and label its parts.

9. Identify the main clause and the subordinate clause in: 'The bridge, which had stood for two centuries, finally collapsed during the flood.'

10. Which sentence below is punctuated correctly as a compound sentence joined by a semicolon? A) The storm passed; the sun came out. B) The storm passed, the sun came out. C) The storm passed: the sun came out. D) The storm passed the sun came out. E) The storm passed — , the sun came out.

11. Rewrite 'The alarm rang. Everyone evacuated. The fire brigade arrived.' as one sentence that is both compound and complex.

12. Identify two subordinate clauses and one main clause in: 'If the forecast is right and the wind drops, the race will start on time.'

13. Explain why 'Despite trying her hardest' is a fragment, and turn it into a complete complex sentence.

14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly combine a main clause with a relative subordinate clause? A) The book, which I borrowed from the library, is overdue. B) The book which I borrowed from the library overdue is. C) I borrowed the book, which is overdue, from the library. D) The book is overdue which I borrowed. E) The book that I borrowed is overdue.

15. Write a sentence with one main clause and two subordinate clauses (one at the start, one embedded in the middle), then label all three parts.

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